***Starlight Graveyard***

*General Setting:*
You joined your father on a research expedition with his crew to this megastructure. You were infected by a space fungus, and he locks you away to protect you while the look for a cure. The fungus itself is a community that decided to join collectively to become one organism, and its continued existence is the function and purpose of the megastructure.

*The Itch:*
The player wakes up in their cryopod to failing stasis. They see a note on the glass facing inwards. “Stay here, I'll be back soon. You are going to be ok. - Dad”. Looking outside, it is obvious years have passed. Shortly after, the player finds a looping audiolog from a distress beacon. “If you are hearing this, I didn't make it in time and stasis has failed. But I was wrong, it isn't what we thought it was. Come find me, it won't hurt you, it … it won't … *static*… (message repeats).”

*The Payoff:*
At a fungal heart/core, the player finds that their father is “dead”. They assimilated with the fungal community and have left the player a choice. Join them, use a cure, or leave it all behind.
Join: You join the community with your father, succumb to your infection, and accept that he made the right choice.
Cure: You finish a device he could not and use it to cure yourself and destroy him along with the fungus.
Leave: You leave, though the infection has taken hold. The game ends with the fungus itself going dormant in your body, implying that the fungal community respects your decision to leave as an act of goodwill and potentially the final will of your father.

*Characters:*

*The Father:*
The expedition leader. When desperate or threatened, he tends to lock away those he wants to keep safe instead of ask for help. Over the course of the game, the player should witness growth from him in this regard, seeking help from his crew instead of barking orders, and his eventual personal revelations when he decides to surrender individuality for community when he joins the fungus.

*The Drone:*
A companion in an otherwise lonely game. It will fly around, scanning objects, as well as interacting with objects in the world, playing audiologs, and potentially making comments of its own to the player at key moments. I don't think I want it to be a constant source of dialogue.

*The Fungus:*
A collective of moss and fungal growth, mushrooms, etc.. that brightens and darkens. Over the course of the game, it “interacts” in ways beneficial to the player, helping them progress. Opening doors, lighting dark passageways, giving hints, etc.. It has a dual purpose for the player. Is it leading the player? Or is it luring them in?

*The Crew:*
I'm not entirely sure what story beats I'll want to put in here, but the idea is that these are recurring characters that support what it feels like the game needs at the time. The player will periodically find their bodies during exploration and get nuggets of story. Think the dead soldiers in Metroid Prime 2.

*Chapters:*

***demo***

*Prologue/Tutorial:*

1. Initial story hook, basic movement and control tutorials.
2. The player meets their drone companion.
3. Empty corridors of the expedition spaceship. Large and open spaces for expedition training. The player fixes a few ship components before leaving.

*Chapter 1 – Megastructure Entrance:*

1. The player leaves their ship and approaches the megastructure.
2. They practice what they learned in the tutorial in escalating difficulty to navigate the space.

***game***

*Chapter 2 – The Veins:*

1. Tight corridors, locked doors, and security measures.
2. The player gains a boost break ability to smash through weak walls and structures.
3. They follow a river of coolant leading to the next area

*Chapter 3 – The Coolant Sea:*

1. The player gains the use of deployable magnetized lights to navigate the ocean.
2. They travel sea currents to aid in traversal.

*Chapter 4 – The Garden:*

1. A large garden of mushrooms with various effects the player navigates through.
2. Certain mushrooms can be activated to enable currents of spores.
3. Mushroom hazards:
    1. Mushroom that explodes and pushes you away if you get too close.
    2. Mushroom that shocks you, preventing thrust for a period of time.
    3. Oxygen bubbles you need to force yourself into using boost break.
    4. Etc.., play around with ideas.

*Chapter 5 – Silence and Ruin:*

1. The player gathers parts to construct a cure for the fungal infection, and information leading them to the fungal heart.
2. Care is taken to ensure it makes use of all the mechanics from earlier in the game, and they should also be combined to add greater challenge.
3. An ancient city, and what was left behind.

*Chapter 6? – Chapter 5 might need splitting*

*Ending – The Fungal Heart:*

1. The player makes the final choice.
2. A big 'ol heart mushroom, you know the type. It should beat like a real heart, even though it makes no sense.